💐 Wreaths & Floral Design: Reading

Horticulture 1 · Unit 9 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Wreaths/Swags, Harvest Centerpiece, Succulent Planter, plant sale

Name: _____

Seasonal Projects and Floral Design

Many horticulture businesses earn much of their money from seasonal products. In fall and winter, growers and florists make harvest centerpieces, wreaths and swags. A wreath is a circular frame covered with bundles of evergreen tips, attached with floral or paddle wire. Each bundle overlaps the one before so the wire is hidden. A swag is a flat bundle of greens tied at the top and hung on a door or wall.

Floral designers follow design principles. Balance means the arrangement looks evenly weighted. The focal point is the area that draws the eye first. Proportion means the size of the arrangement fits its container and setting. Color harmony means the colors work well together. A table centerpiece, like a harvest arrangement in a hollowed pumpkin, is kept low so guests can see each other.

Succulents, such as jade and echeveria, store water in thick leaves. They grow best in fast-draining cactus mix and need only light watering; too much water causes rot. Succulent planters are popular sale items. Some succulents and cacti have spines, so they should be handled by the pot.

To sell products, growers keep an inventory and set prices. A simple price adds the cost of materials, the cost of labor and a profit. Safety matters in seasonal projects: holly and mistletoe berries are poisonous, pruners and wire require care, glue guns should be low-temperature and staff-run, and pumpkins are carved by staff.

Check your reading

1. Describe how a wreath is built.

2. Explain two floral design principles.

3. How is a selling price calculated?